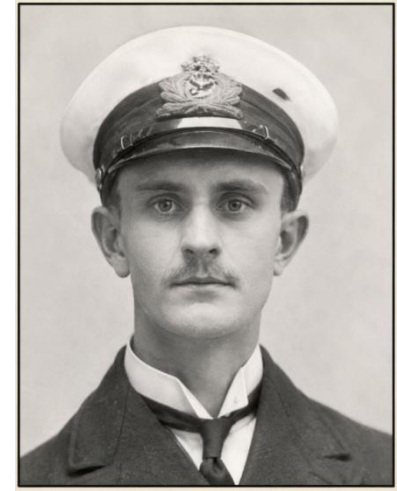




Joseph Hugh Taylor

1897 - 1918

Civilian Research

Field Name	Field Data	Source of data
Casualty Name	J Taylor J H Taylor – Joe Taylor Joseph Hugh Taylor	Plaque at school Students' research CWGC – see link https://www.cwgc.org/find-records/find-war-dead/casualty-details/626607/joseph-hugh-taylor/ Flight Sub-Lieutenant, Royal Air Force, G Squadron (from CWGC)
Date of Birth	1/4/1897	GWR employee records
Date of Death	17/4/1918 His death was reported in the Lyonian	CWGC Students' research
Age at death	21	Based on birth and death dates
Marital Status	I'm assuming single	
Children (if any)		

Occupation prior to Call up	Engineer at the GWR Works, Swindon from 1914 till joining up	Students' research GWR apprentice records, see below
Parents	Joseph Arthur Taylor and Annie Adelaide Taylor	1911 census
Listed Address(s)	Assuming somewhere near/in Swindon from 1914 52 Warrington Rd, Harrow, living with parents and sister, he was 14	GWR apprentice records, see below 1911 census
Parents /Fathers occupation	Merchant's Clerk, East India Company	1911 census
Brothers and Sisters	Marie Adelaide Taylor (younger)	1911 census
Years at John Lyon School		
University (if any)	Technical Schools – evening classes while he was working	Newspaper report see below
Obituary	See below – students and newspaper which relied heavily on Lyonian at the time	
Additional sources of data		
War Memorials:	John Lyon School, plaque as J Taylor	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11204
	John Lyon School, sundial as J Taylor	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11318
	Pinner War Memorial as JH Taylor	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11095

Military Research

JLS WWI RoH	TAYLOR J.H.	
CWGC Reference	https://www.cwgc.org/find-records/find-war-dead/casualty-details/626607/joseph-hugh-taylor/	
Age		
DoD	17-Apr-18	
Rank	Flt Sub Lt	
Regiment	G Squadron RAF	
Location	EAST MUDROS MILITARY CEMETERY III. H. 239. Greece	
Military details	Flight Sub-Lieutenant Joseph Hugh Taylor was 19 years old when he died. Official service records and military casualty logs confirm that he was born in 1898 (making him either 19 or just turning 20 depending on his exact birth month). He was a young airman when his Airco DH.4 aircraft (serial number B9485) tragically nosedived, crashed, and caught fire right after taking off on an operational flight from the airfield at Mudros.	

Story of Sacrifice

Joseph Hugh “Joe” Taylor (1897–1918)

Joseph Hugh “Joe” Taylor was a John Lyon pupil and skilled engineer who worked at the Great Western Railway while continuing his technical studies.

He later served with the Royal Naval Air Service, flying bombing and reconnaissance missions before being killed in a training accident in Greece in April 1918, aged 21.

Civilian Life

Joseph Taylor, known as “Joe” Taylor, was born on 1 April 1897, the son of Joseph and Annie Taylor. In 1911 he was living with his parents and younger sister, Marie Adelaide, at 52 Warrington Road, Harrow. His father was a merchant’s clerk with the East India Company.

Joe was educated at the Lower School of John Lyon and, after leaving school, became an engineer at the Great Western Railway works at Swindon in 1914. While working, he continued his education through evening classes at the Technical Schools. He also regularly returned to his old school during holidays, where he remained in contact with former teachers and pupils.

Military Life

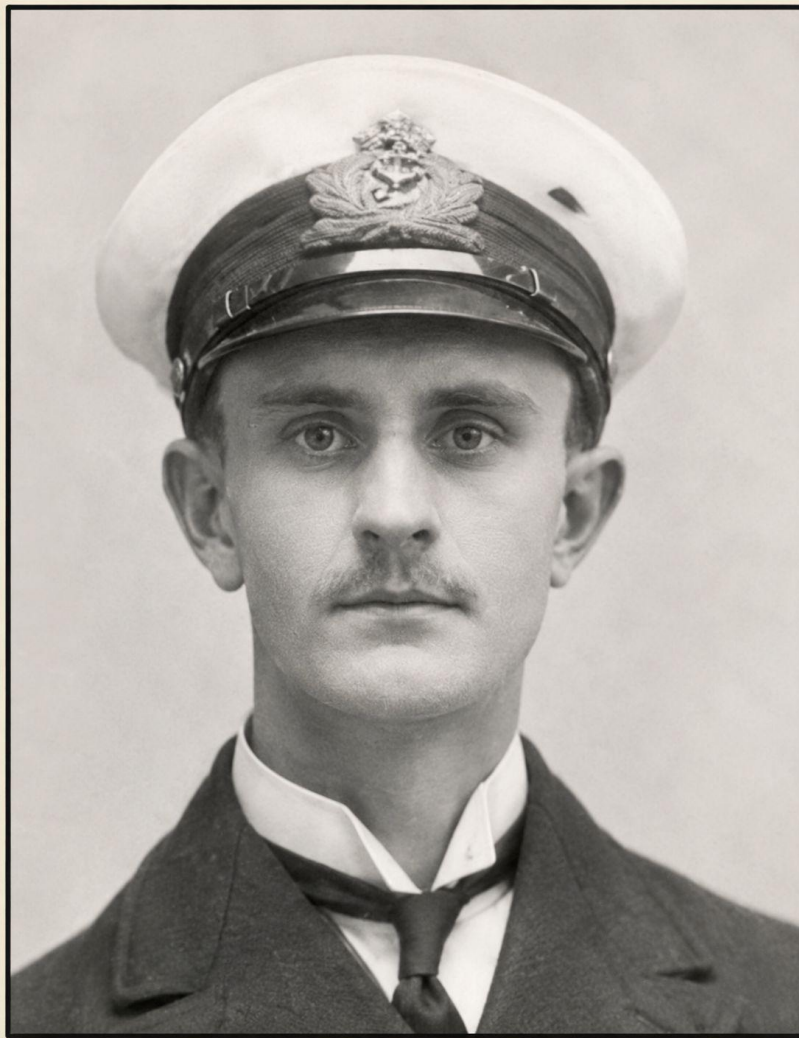
Taylor joined the Royal Naval Air Service and served as a Flight Sub-Lieutenant. Before his death he took part in bombing and reconnaissance flights over the Gallipoli Peninsula. He was subsequently killed on 17 April 1918 during a test flight.

According to his commanding officer, Taylor was taking off for a practice flight in a modern two-seater aircraft when the engine failed. While attempting to avoid hills ahead, the aircraft side-slipped into the ground, killing him instantly. His commanding officer, who had known him for about two years, stated that he had formed a “very high opinion” of him. Taylor was 21 years old and was buried at Mudros Cemetery in Greece. The *Lyonian* reported his death with “deep and unfeigned grief”, remembering him as a modest, worthy and respected former pupil whose career had been cut short. His death was also reported in the *Uxbridge & West Drayton Gazette*, which reproduced the school's tribute and recorded the sympathy expressed for his parents.

Photos



Taylor Photo Original #1 OK TO USE



Taylor Photo AI #1 OK TO USE



Taylor Photo AI #3 **Permission requested 28th July 2026**



Taylor Photo Original #2 **Permission requested 28th July 2026**



Taylor Photo AI #2 **Permission requested 28th July 2026**



Taylor Photo Original #2 **Permission requested 28th July 2026**

Notes and Clippings

From the Centenary issue of the Lyonian,
researched by Pupils 2014



Taylor, J H

Joe Taylor served with the Royal Navy Air Service and was killed during an accident while on a test flight. His commanding officer reported that, "he was leaving the ground for a practice flight in a modern type of two seater, when his engine failed, and in trying to avoid some hills in front of him, he side-slipped into the ground and was killed at once." He went

on to say that Joe "had been under my command for about two years and I had a very high opinion of him." Before his death Joe had taken part in several bombing and reconnaissance flights over the Gallipoli Peninsula. He is buried in Greece at the Mudros Cemetery.

The Lyonian reported his death with a sense of "deep and unfeigned grief" and described him as "a more modest, more worthy, more respected Lyonian never came to us and the sad fatality has cut short a life full of promise." Prior to his death he was working as an engineer on the Great Western Railway and often came back to visit the School.

From the Centenary issue of the Lyonian,
researched by pupils 2014

Taylor, J H

Joe Taylor served with the Royal Navy Air Service and was killed during an accident while on a test flight. His commanding officer reported that, "he was leaving the ground for a practice flight in a modern type of two seater, when his engine failed, and in trying to avoid some hills in front of him, he side-slipped into the ground and was killed at once." He went on to say that Joe "had been under my command for about two years and I had a very high opinion of him." Before his death Joe had taken part in several bombing and reconnaissance flights over the Gallipoli Peninsula. He is buried in Greece at the Mudros Cemetery.

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Monks).

PINNER SOLDIER KILLED.

Recently we reported in these columns the death of Lieutenant Joseph Taylor, R.N.A.S., of Hatch End, Pinner, who was accidentally killed. He formerly resided at Harrow, and "The Lyonian" Magazine, of the Lower School of John Lyon, gives the following fine tribute of his life: "We have to announce the accidental death of Lieutenant Joseph Taylor, R.N.A.S. We do not know any details, but his service was one of constant and increasing danger. It was with deep and unfeigned grief that we heard of poor Joe's death. A more modest, more worthy, more respected Lyonian never came to us, and the sad fatality has cut short a career full of life and promise. Joe had been since his school days, until he entered the R.N.A.S., following his profession as engineer at the G.W.R. works, Swindon, and continuing his studies in the Technical Schools, after work hours. On his holidays he always made it a point of honour to re-visit his old school, and many a pleasant hour have we passed discussing Swindonia and Lyonia. To his parents his loss must needs seem terrible, since to us it is so constantly recurring in all its sad poignancy. All Lyonians who knew poor Joe Taylor will join us in the most sincere sympathy with them.'

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Great Western Railway Employee Records – Premium Apprentices

Birth		Date started			Fitting & Turning Trade			
480	1	4	1897	2	2	1914	Taylor, Joseph Hugh	- do. -

Premium	No. Yrs	Stn: Swindon Loco	Rate/yr as shown per/day				Remarks – NB dofd is incorrect probably			
£100	(to 5 years) 5	- do -	"	10	1/2	1/6	2/-	2/6	Mil. duty, from 28-2-16 Killed in action 16/18.	5391/a
									Mil. duty from 28-2-16 Retd 2/1/19	

The following pictures are from 2 diff family trees on Ancestry – we have attempted to contact the owners of the trees Permission requested 28th July 2026



Joseph Hugh Taylor



 **Description:** In RAF uniform. Royal Naval Air Service merged with newly formed RAF. RAF uniform was almost the same as army uniform.

[illegible]

RAF Officer service records (Ancestry) (nothing on second page)

21

Joseph. Hugh. NAVAL

Christian Names (in full) Joseph. Hugh. **Surname** Laylor
Date of Birth 1st April 1897. **Permanent Home Address**
Name of Person to be Name J. A. Taylor **Address** 2 Woodringtons Av.
Informed of Casualties Hatch End, Middlesex. **Relationship** Father
A.M.E.R.A.S. **Draft Sheet Started** 24-7-18. **Registered Papers No.** R.P. 43414

MOVEMENTS						MOVEMENTS (continued)					
Outgoing Authority	Unit from which	Unit to which	Date of Effect	Special Remarks or Duties	Training Author by Qualification	Outgoing Authority	Unit from which	Unit to which	Date of Effect	Special Remarks or Duties	Training Authority
	Lt. Palace	Lt. Palace	24-6-17		also 71						
	Hedean	Hedean	24-9-17								
	Grahamwell	Grahamwell	2-11-17								
	Grahamwell	Mantion	3-12-17								
	Cancelled	Bombardier	24-1-18								
	No 2 Wg.		24-1-18								
Killed 7-4-18											

APPOINTMENTS AND PROMOTIONS				
Date of Last Grant	Rank *	Description	Graded as	Date of Effect
11 Dec 17	T.F.O.			10-6-17
11 Dec 17	2d Sub Lt.			11-10-17
11 Dec 17	1st Lt.			16-9-17
11 Dec 17				1-11-18

FOR THE GRANT OF WARRANTS